

Exchange Server SE

What happens on-premises in 2025?

Thomas Stensitzki



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Thomas Stensitzki



- 20 Years Exchange Experience
- Author, Blogger, Podcaster
- MCT Regional Lead
- Vinyl record collector

“Don't dream it, be it.”



<https://linktr.ee/stensitzki>



Exchange
Expert

#ScottishSummit2024

What we know so far

A quick reminder



Product Name

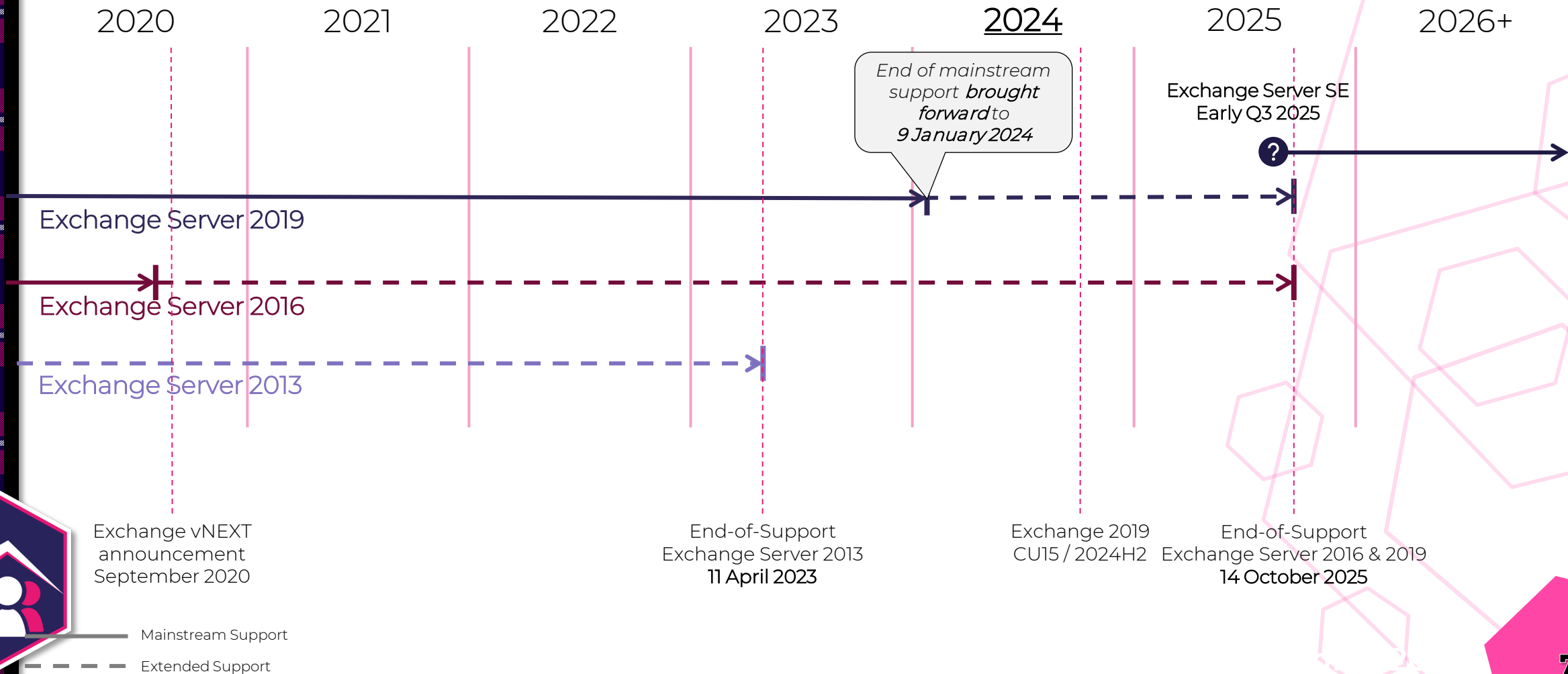


- Exchange Server vNext
 - Exchange Server Subscription Edition
 - Short: Exchange Server SE

Exchange Server Life-Cycle

Product	Available since	Mainstream Support ends	Extended Support ends
Exchange Server 2019 → 7 years life-span	22 October 2018	9 January 2024	14 October 2025
Exchange Server 2016 → 10 years life-span	1 October 2015	13 October 2020	14 October 2025
<i>Exchange Server 2013</i> → 10 years life-span	<i>9 January 2013</i>	<i>10 April 2018</i>	<i>11 April 2023</i>

Never ending Story



Just the facts, please



- Two Exchange Server 2019 cumulative updates after the end of mainstream support
 - CU14 – 2024H1 → 13 February 2024 ✓
 - CU15 – 2024H2 → Fall 2024



Exchange Server 2019 CU15



- Support for TLS 1.3
- Return of certificate management in Admin Center

Other expected changes

- Enhanced Antimalware Scan Interface (AMSI)
- Removal of OWA Instant Messaging and UCMA 6.0
- Windows MSMQ not part of setup anymore

Upcoming Exchange Server Releases

Release	Release target	Remarks	Coexistence
Exchange Server 2019 CU15	H2 CY 2024	Final CU for Exchange Server 2019	No coexistence with Exchange 2013 Setup blocks installation
Exchange Server SE RTM	Early H2 CY 2025	Enables in-place upgrade from Exchange 2019 CU14 or CU15 Code parity with Exchange 2019 CU15 + any Security Update since CU15	No coexistence with Exchange 2013 Setup blocks installation
Exchange Server SE CU1	Late H2 2025	First new features in Exchange Server SE	No coexistence with Exchange 2013, 2016, or 2019 Setup blocks installation



Exchange Server 2019 CU15



- Blocks coexistence with unsupported Exchange versions
- No coexistence with Exchange Server 2013
- New product keys from Volume License Center (VLSC)

Exchange Server 2019 CU15 + SE



- CU15 introduces support for Windows Server 2025
- SE requires licensing by Software Assurance or Microsoft 365 cloud licenses
- Hybrid Exchange Servers (aka Coexistence Role) receive a free license
 - Hybrid Configuration Wizard assigns a license to unlicensed servers
 - Edge Transport Servers still require a full license

Exchange Server SE CU1

What happens after RTM release?



Exchange Server SE CU1



- Planned for late H2 of 2025



Exchange Server SE CU1



Planned Updates

- Kerberos for Server-to-Server Authentication
 - NTLMv2 replacement
 - Negotiate:Kerberos activated for all virtual directories
- Introduction of REST-based Admin API
 - Remote PowerShell will still be supported

Exchange Server SE CU1



Planned Updates

- No coexistence with Exchange Server 2016 & 2019
 - Setup blocks installation, if any unsupported versions of Exchange are present in Active Directory, including subscribed Edge Transport servers
- Removal of OutlookAnywhere

Upgrade Options

What are your choices?



Exchange Server SE – Upgrade Options

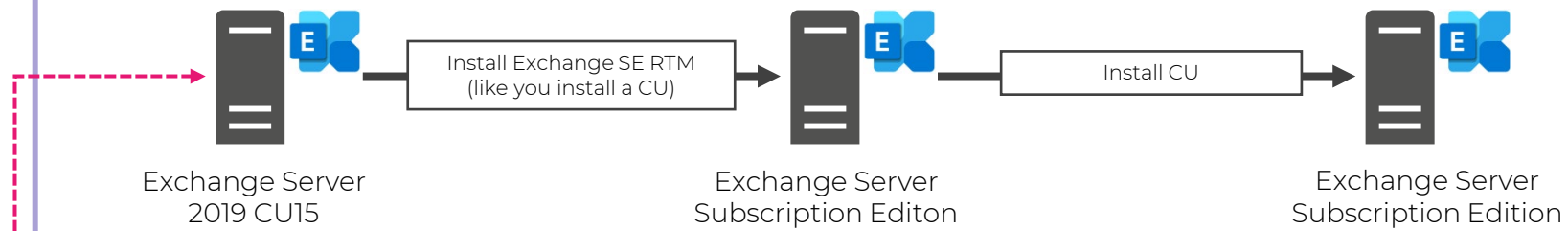


- Legacy Upgrade
 - Prepare Schema, Active Directory and Domains
 - Install new Exchange Server, including all corresponding tasks
 - DAG configuration, mailbox moves, etc.
 - Decommission old Exchange Servers
- Modern Servicing
 - In-Place upgrade like you do with cumulative updates
 - Repeat installation for each server in your organisation

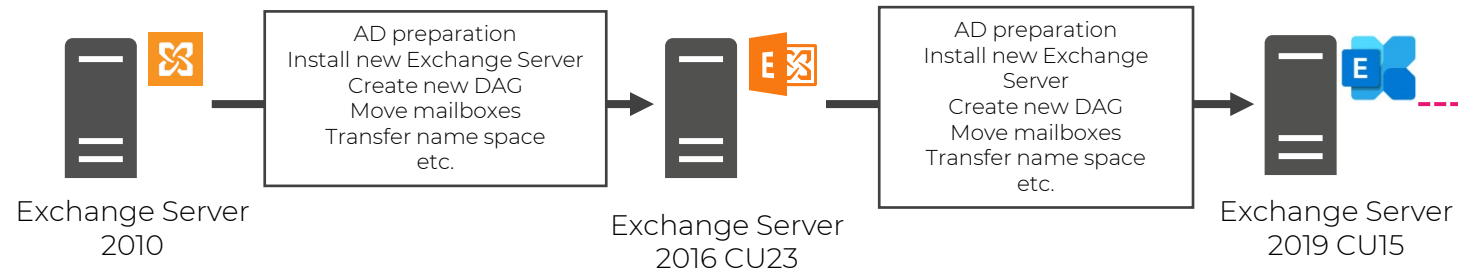
Modern Servicing vs. Legacy Upgrade



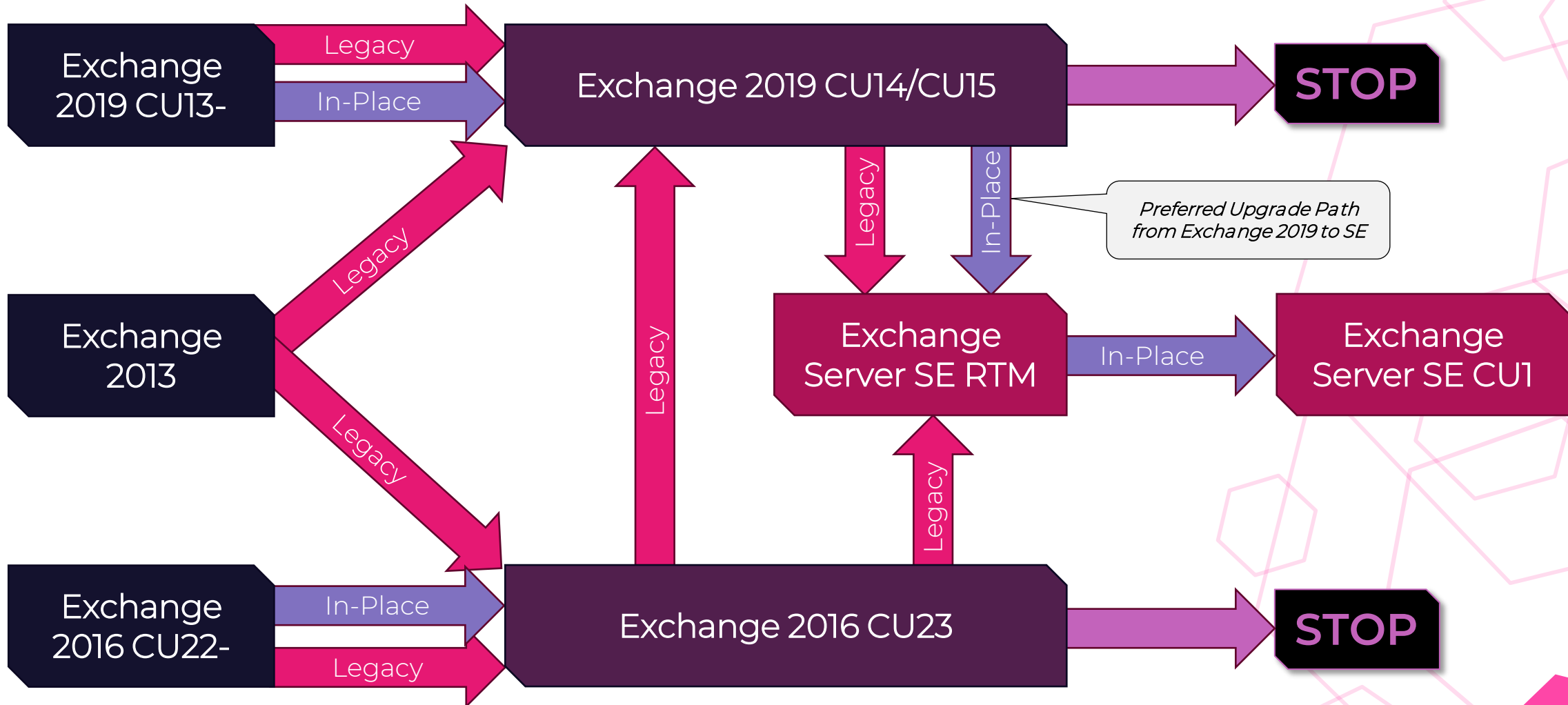
Modern Servicing



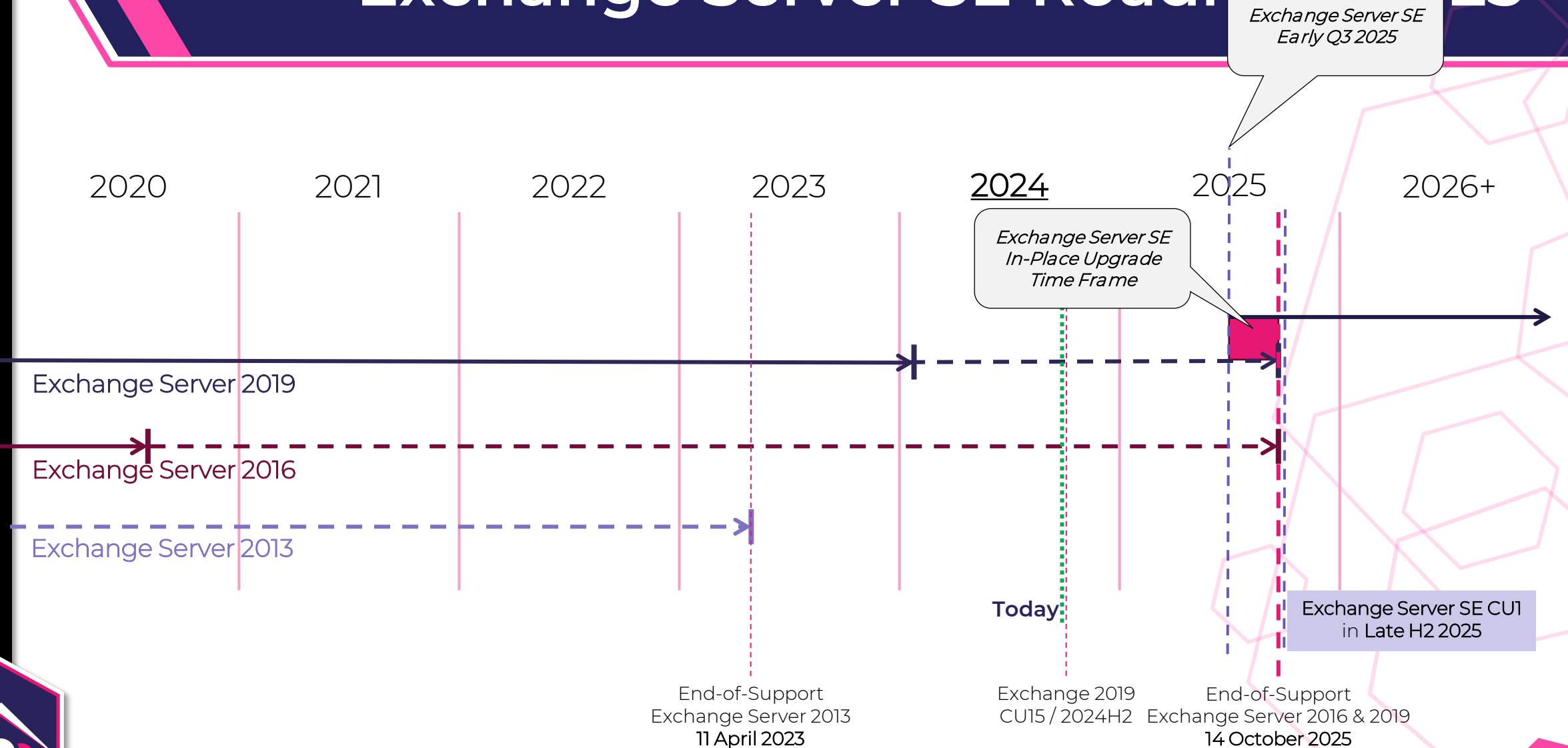
Legacy Upgrade



Exchange Server SE Migration Paths

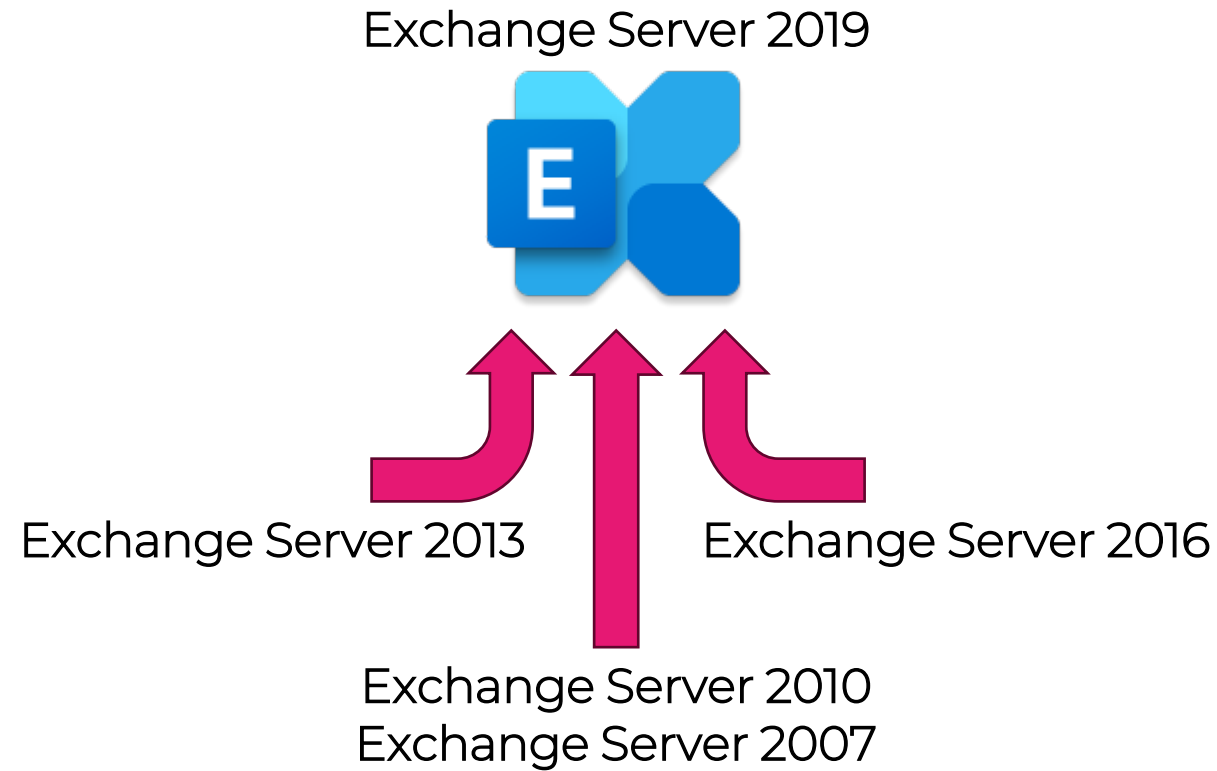


Exchange Server SE Roadmap 2025



— Mainstream Support
- - - Extended Support

Migrate to Exchange Server 2019 today



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Exchange Server SE



“It's ready, when it's ready.”



“We’re very excited about the Next release of Exchange Server and we hope our customers will be, too.”

-Scott Schnoll, Microsoft

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